

IT Hardware and Communications Equipment

Highlights from Meetings in Asia

We met with companies across the IT Hardware supply chain in Asia last week. The takes were positive, as demand across segments was favorable. A lot of the incremental discussion was on capacity limitations, component shortages, and multi sourcing. We remain positive on our AI focused names.

Compute

Our take from the compute ecosystem is that demand continues to outstrip supply, with not much relief in sight. We have a favorable view on most of our companies that have exposure.

TPU

When we visited Asia six months ago, one of our main calls was being positive on TPU-exposed vendors as we heard of a doubling of capacity in early 2026, and a potential raise of 50% in mid-2026. We believe this is developing at or above that plan. Most EMS vendors have a play here.

- **CLS.** We view CLS as the main supplier to TPU and variants, regardless of silicon provider. We are modeling more than a double of TPU-related revenues in 2026 to \$2.8Bn from \$1Bn in 2025. We are less concerned about others being added to the supply chain given the overall growth profile of TPU.
- **FLEX.** FLEX has traditionally been the second source for CPU manufacture. While there has been some concern about share loss, we think FLEX is still involved, even if revenues don't grow like the rest of the ecosystem. FLEX would likely supply lower related products to this ecosystem as well.
- **JBL.** While we do not believe JBL is directly linked to TPU, the company makes the test equipment for the main provider of testing hardware. We see steady growth in testing capacity as a positive for this segment at JBL.
- **Other ODMs.** We believe there is more ODM activity in this supply chain, particularly for the TPU motherboard and the full rack assembly, where GOOG had been vertically integrated. We don't view these changes as meaningful to our companies at this time.

Trainium

The supply chain sees solid Trainium unit growth this year, but not to the magnitude of TPU. We believe something like 30%+ is more reasonable, and potentially higher if the solution is more broadly adopted by other cloud players.

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- **FN.** The ramp at FN has been impressive, even with the slight miss last quarter. We believe the increased production lines and incremental business will lead to a further ramp of revenues over the next year or two. We did not pick up any indications of a third source entering this market.
- **JBL.** For full racks, we believe JBL entered the supply chain in a more meaningful way in mid-2025 with increased Trainium rack construction in a competitive win.

Other accelerator

We have been disappointed by the other major accelerator launch expected over the last few years. There seems to be a little activity with MSFT's Maia program, though timing and volumes are still uncertain. The META project seems to be further from commercialization. It's unclear at this time if the NA EMS companies will have a meaningful play in this area.

- **NVDA GPU and AMD.** While the supply chain mentions potential delays to both programs, we see strong ramps at the end of this year. Many of our companies play across these ecosystems.
 - DELL should remain strongly positioned in GPU based servers given the issues at SMCI and the new capacity coming on-line in Texas.
 - CLS looks well positioned to win scale up Ethernet business as these AI clusters ramp.
 - FN is a leading supplier of transceivers to NVDA, and 1.6T should start to reinvigorate growth.
 - JBL is one of the manufacturers for NVDA's switching equipment, which is often pulled through with compute.
 - FLEX would be one of the suppliers to power systems and potentially racks for these deployments.
 - ANET would be well positioned for the AI front and back ends in AMD clusters.
 - SANM (not covered) would also be well positioned in AMD powered data centers as per indications from our meetings.

Cloud CPU

Compared to six months ago, the outlook for general purpose CPU is much improved with unit discussions moving from flat to up 20-40%, and higher ASPs. A lot of this supply chain favors Asian ODMs over North American EMS, but the increased builds should provide a more favorable backdrop for EMS and the networking companies.

Enterprise

The tone for enterprise server has been somewhat consistent with talk of flat to slightly growing units and higher ASPs. DELL was highlighted as doing well here.

Networking

There is less networking in the Asia supply chain, though we did meet with one of the major white box players, and had reads from other industry participants.

DC Switching

Demand for switching is strong and is tracking with increased compute spend. Scale up Ethernet is in the early phases but seems like it could be a 2027 driver for the ecosystem.

- **CLS.** While we heard no direct data points, the switching TAM for those using white box continues to expand, and we view CLS as the main beneficiary. We heard of a ramp at AWS from a major WB competitor, but we still see leading share and strong growth for CLS. Meta will likely remain more competitive for all players.
- **JBL.** We believe JBL is the time beneficiary for NVDA switches. Given the strong GPU outlook, we see continued growth here.
- **ANET.** We came away with two indirect positives for ANET in our meetings. First, the inflection in Cloud CPU servers is meaningful for the front end networking market, where we view ANET as a leader. Second, there did not seem to be much activity for newer cloud companies accelerating their white box strategies. As such, we see a lot more new customer activity for the best-in-breed branded vendor, with CSCO also seeing opportunities.

Campus Switching

Like with the enterprise server market, there was not a lot of growth expectation for campus switching and WiFi. The supply chain sees LSD-MSD, just at the low end of our model. JNPR/HPE was highlighted as doing well.

Power

The power market is much more fragmented as products span the boards, racks, and full data centers. It was clear from our meetings that the incremental power (and cooling) requirements per rack are growing. It's hard to put a number to this growth, but in-line with compute could be a good proxy.

- **FLEX.** FLEX is the most exposed to power with \$2.1Bn of revenue in FY26 growing 61%. With the announcement of an almost 2x of growth in FY27 and FY28 for the cloud/AI business, we view the company as a market share gainer in this segment.
- **JBL.** We estimate JBL annual power revenues at ~\$600M/year and also growing 30%+. The recent addition of Hanley should further bolster this business.

Devices

The device segment is being much more impacted by the increased memory prices given more exposure, and more of a consumer mix in the end market.

- **PCs.** We recently discussed weak numbers across the PC supply chain for the month of April. The ODM are expecting a rebound later in Q2, and most are expecting units to be down 5-10% for the year, slightly better than our industry model.
- **Smartphones.** Similarly, unit expectations for phones are weak this year. We did hear about some weakness creeping into the high-end Android market (excluding Samsung), which we view as new. iPhones continue to sell well in China, with some industry participants seeing pricing/promotion activity from the high-end vendor helping to maintain the momentum. We question the sustainability for AAPL.
- **Cameras.** We met with a leading video security company that competes with MSI. While there are some pressures, there is more of a secular growth dynamic in security. We believe increased ASPs will help revenues across the ecosystem, and we also see MSI as a share gainer.

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Arista Networks, Inc. (ANET, 15-May-2026, USD 141.97), Overweight/Neutral, J

Celestica Inc. (CLS, 15-May-2026, USD 358.55), Overweight/Neutral, J

Cisco Systems, Inc. (CSCO, 15-May-2026, USD 118.21), Equal Weight/Neutral, CD/CE/D/J/K/L/M

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